

STAGES OF MIGRATION

1500 BCE

The Lapita people begin their travels across the Pacific Ocean using canoes called outriggers and navigating with the help of the stars, birds, winds, and tides.



MODEL OF A POLYNESIAN
OUTRIGGER CANOE

c. 1500–1000 BCE

Lapita people arrive in Fiji and soon continue further to Tonga, Samoa, and other islands. They take plants and animals with them to establish small villages on new islands.

800–1000 CE

A second stage of eastward expansion takes place, and Polynesian explorers from Tahiti, Tonga, and Samoa travel to and settle Rapa Nui, the Cook Islands, and Hawaii.

c. 1280 CE

The Lapita people reach what they call “Aotearoa” (modern-day New Zealand) and their society flourishes and develops into the Māori culture.

